ALEXUS KARL JOAQUIN

Senior Full Stack Lead Engineer · AI-Native Development · Published iOS App Developer
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PROFILE

Senior Full Stack Lead Engineer with 8 years of experience taking complex platforms from blank page to production — and 4+ years leading engineering teams while staying deeply hands-on. One of the earliest adopters of AI-native development in his organizations: introduced Model Context Protocol (MCP), Claude Code, and Cursor AI company-wide and retrained entire teams around AI-powered workflows, fundamentally changing how software gets shipped. Designed, built, and launched a commercial iOS finance app — Cashn't — solo, from product design through App Store release, and has since shipped a portfolio of seven more products end to end.

WHY HIRE ME

- **Full product ownership, proven publicly.** Shipped Cashn't, a paid budget-tracking app live on the Apple App Store, built entirely solo: product design, AI coach, backend API, security, privacy compliance, and App Store review — the complete lifecycle most engineers never touch. Every project below can be tried live at alexuskarljoaquin.com.
- **AI transformation leader, not just user.** Introduced MCP, Claude Code, and Cursor AI to entire engineering organizations, wrote the adoption standards, and trained the engineers. Companies hiring for AI-readiness get someone who has already led that transition twice.
- **Builds from zero, at production quality.** Twice trusted to architect financing platforms from scratch — systems handling real money, where reliability isn't optional — and delivered them with high-availability AWS infrastructure, observability, and automated pipelines.
- **Multiplies teams.** Led and mentored 5-engineer teams at three consecutive companies, running disciplined Agile delivery while raising the technical bar through code review, documentation culture, and hands-on coaching.

SELECTED PROJECTS — BUILT SOLO, ZERO TO DEPLOYMENT

Cashn't — Budget Tracker | Founder, Sole Engineer & Designer *2026 – Present*
Paid iOS finance app, live on the Apple App Store — apps.apple.com/app/id6789244062 · React 19, TypeScript, Capacitor, Express + PostgreSQL on Railway, Firebase Auth

- A "safe to spend today" engine that computes one honest daily number from balances, bills, paydays, and savings goals; net worth across cash, banks, e-wallets (GCash, Maya), investments, and crypto; trip envelopes and group pots with automatic who-owes-who settlement.
- Built an AI money coach into the product — plain-language questions answered with plans generated from the user's actual data — practical, production LLM integration.
- Privacy as a feature: local-first guest mode, Face ID lock, privacy masking, in-app account deletion, published privacy policy — passed App Store review on the first submission; v1.1 shipped within days of launch. Runs the entire product operation: ASO, release management, pricing, roadmap.

LOCA — hyperlocal give / ask / borrow / help app · React, NestJS + Prisma, PostgreSQL, Capacitor iOS, Firebase sign-in, APNs push, S3, Railway

- 34-table schema, end-to-end auth (email, Google, Apple), two-sided borrow handoffs, messaging with live SSE feed, rules-based matching, English/Tagalog + OpenAI moderation, 17 e2e suites, hardened deployment (CSP, HSTS, rate limits). Live on Railway.

Ghostn't — dating app that's open one hour a night · React, Capacitor, Express 5, PostgreSQL, WebSockets, CallKit

- Answers-before-faces matching with a three-night reveal ladder; WebSocket live chat with server-authoritative countdowns; single-round-trip endpoints, keyset pagination, advisory locks; route-level code splitting. API live on Railway, iOS build in App Store review.

Studyverse — student productivity & social learning · React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind 4, Node + PostgreSQL, WebSockets, OpenAI, Capacitor

- Brand and design system built from a scripted SVG pipeline (WCAG AA); AI turns timetable photos into schedules and notes into reviewers with flashcard decks; SWR cache + realtime client so no screen ever shows a skeleton.

Cinemi — AI photo studio · React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind 4, Radix, MediaPipe (WASM)

- Token-driven design system whose reference page reads values live from CSS; slash-command prompt composer, before/after compare, on-device face retouching that never uploads photos; monetization components (credits, rewarded ads).

Job Finder · FastAPI, httpx, PostgreSQL, React, TanStack Query **& Alexus Legal AI** · Next.js 14, OpenAI, PostgreSQL, PWA

- Job Finder aggregates LinkedIn, Indeed, JobStreet and Google Jobs with free direct scrapers and RapidAPI fallbacks, dedupes and caches, and scores every listing 0–100 against a CV. Alexus Legal AI is a streaming, empathetic legal companion for Philippine law with persisted conversations and document-image analysis.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Full Stack Engineer | Cloud Employee *Apr 2025 – Present*

- Lead development of scalable production applications on Ruby on Rails, ReactJS, and PostgreSQL — owning features end to end from database schema and API design through frontend delivery and post-release monitoring.
- Pioneered the company's shift to AI-native engineering: introduced Model Context Protocol (MCP) integrations that connect AI assistants directly to internal tools and data sources, turning AI from a chat toy into a working part of the development pipeline.
- Spearheaded company-wide rollout of Claude Code and Cursor AI — evaluated the tools, made the business case, wrote the usage standards, and personally trained engineers — resulting in visibly faster feature delivery and a team that now builds AI-first by default.
- Authored the organization's AI-assisted development standards and best practices: prompt patterns, code-review rules for AI-generated code, and guardrails that let the team move fast without sacrificing quality.
- Designed and implemented the observability stack with Grafana dashboards and Sentry error tracking — production issues are now caught by alerts, not by customers. Built and maintain the engineering knowledge base in Notion (onboarding guides, architecture decisions, runbooks).

Senior Full Stack Lead Engineer | Capital Source Group *Jan 2024 – Apr 2025*

- Trusted to design, build, and launch the company's core Financing System entirely from scratch — a system processing real financial transactions where correctness and uptime directly affect the business — using Python (Flask, Alembic) on the backend and ReactJS on the frontend.
- Architected the full AWS production environment: RDS for transactional data, Elasticsearch for fast search across financial records, and load balancers for high availability — a resilient architecture built to survive traffic spikes and component failures.
- Engineered Selenium-based web scrapers that automated data collection previously done by hand, removing a manual bottleneck and feeding the platform with fresh, reliable data around the clock.
- Owned the delivery pipeline end to end: CI/CD via GitHub Actions, frontend distribution through S3 + CloudFront, and domain management — one engineer accountable for the entire path from commit to customer.
- Led a team of 5 engineers in a daily-sprint Agile/Scrum environment: ran plannings and retros, unblocked engineers daily, reviewed every significant change, and kept a from-scratch build shipping on schedule.

Senior Full Stack Lead Engineer | Vertere Global Solutions *May 2021 – Jan 2024*

- Spearheaded full-stack development of financing systems over a nearly three-year tenure — Python (Flask, Alembic) backends and ReactJS frontends — carrying products through multiple major iterations while keeping them stable in production.
- Fully integrated the AWS stack — Elasticsearch, RDS, load balancers, S3, and CloudFront — designing for both performance and fault tolerance so the platform stayed responsive as usage grew.
- Implemented Selenium-based data pipelines and stood up CI/CD on GitHub Actions, replacing risky manual deployments with repeatable, automated releases; owned end-to-end system stability — monitoring, tuning, and hardening.
- Led and mentored a 5-member engineering team, instilling Agile/Scrum discipline with daily sprints and growing junior engineers into confident, independent contributors.

Software Engineer | FurtherEdge Co. *May 2018 – Jan 2021*

- Recruited on the strength of freelance work delivered while still a second-year college student — client-facing web applications built with Angular frontends and Python backends, shipped to real users on real deadlines.
- Designed and built RESTful APIs, database-backed features, and user-friendly interfaces across a wide variety of client projects; deployed and hosted production applications on AWS (S3, EC2, RDS).
- Contributed to larger-scale team projects in a structured professional environment — all while completing a BS in Information Technology, graduating Magna Cum Laude.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Python (Flask, Django, FastAPI), Ruby on Rails, JavaScript/TypeScript, ReactJS, Next.js, NestJS, Angular, Tailwind CSS

AI & Automation: LLM Integration, Model Context Protocol (MCP), AI Agents, Claude Code, Cursor AI, Prompt Engineering, Workflow Automation

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, CloudFront, Load Balancers), Docker, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Railway

Data & Observability: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Prisma, Grafana, Sentry

Mobile & Product: iOS App Development (Capacitor, CallKit), App Store Publishing & Review, Product Design, Design Systems, Release Management

Practices: Software Architecture, System Design, RESTful APIs, Performance Optimization, Agile/Scrum, Technical Documentation (Notion)

EDUCATION

BS Information Technology, Magna Cum Laude *2016 – 2020*

Nueva Ecija University of Science and Technology